Vopak

South Africa liquid fuels market outlook

Demand, supply and routes — implications for Vopak

Durban and Lesedi | Market-sizing framework

11 October 2026

Planning estimates and illustrative capture. Customer access and usable capacity remain to be established.

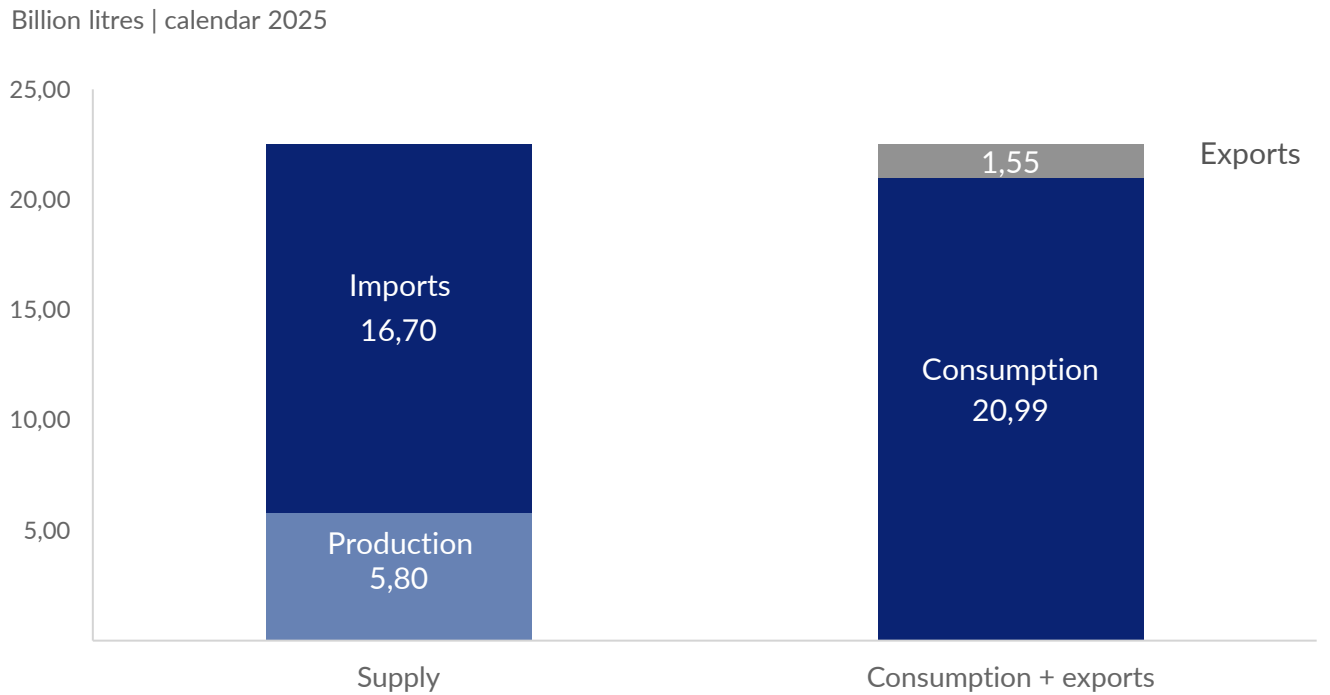
Photo source: Royal Vopak | Terminal Durban | vopak.com



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2025 production and imports broadly cover consumption and exports

2025 petrol and diesel balance



Production + imports − exports = 20.95bn L available, versus 20.99bn L estimated consumption.

Reported trade; estimated domestic balance

Supply: 5.80bn L assumed production + 16.70bn L recorded imports.

Uses: 20.99bn L estimated consumption + 1.55bn L recorded exports.

Supply is 0.034bn L below uses. Stock change is unmeasured; the gap remains a reconciliation item.

Petrol and diesel differences offset: −2.00bn L and +1.97bn L respectively.

Analytical workbook v02, Balance; SARS calendar-2025 customs. Demand estimated; production assumed; trade recorded. Stock change and statistical/scope differences unresolved. Values rounded; the 0.034bn L gap uses unrounded data.

Changes in demand, domestic supply and import routes could reduce flows through Durban

Complication	Driver	What changes for fuel demand and Durban flows
Baseline	Baseline demand | p4	Estimated 21.0bn-litre market in 2025; petrol/diesel history and the end-use split establish the starting point.
1 Demand	Sector activity | p5	Mining, manufacturing and agriculture drive equipment and freight demand along different growth paths.
	Eskom recovery | p6	Reliable electricity reduces peaking and backup diesel at utilities, mines, factories and farms.
	Road-to-rail | p7	Freight shifted from trucks reduces road diesel use; net savings depend on rail traction.
	Vehicle sales p8 | Efficiency p9	Lower fuel consumption per kilometre reduces demand at a given level of road activity.
2 Domestic supply	Refinery history p10 | Outlook p14	Higher production displaces imports; outages or lower output increase import dependence.
3 Import routes	Ports and inland connections | p11	Matola competes for inland supply. Assess Walvis Bay, pipeline access and delivered cost; Walvis Bay diversion is unquantified.

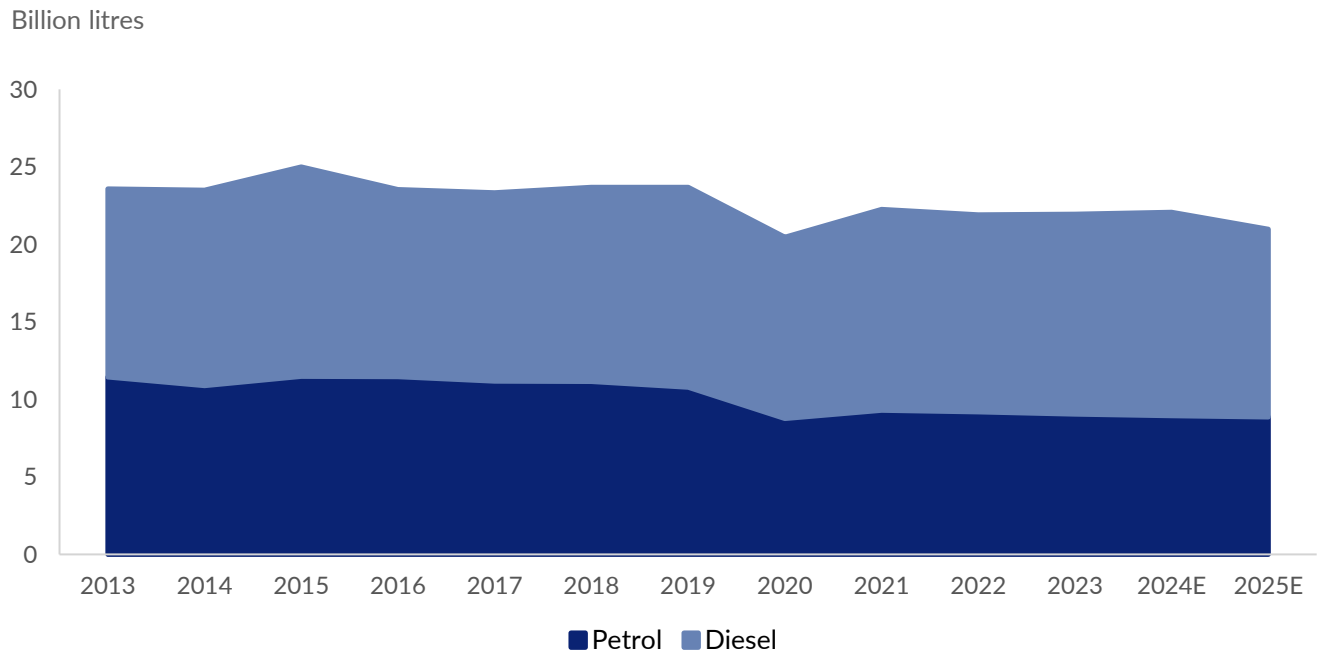
A large national import market does not automatically translate into growth for Vopak.

Demand baseline: p4. Driver evidence: pp5–11. Restored import outlook: p14. Stats SA; Eskom; Sasol; Glencore; Galp; Petromoc; naamsa. Scenario outcomes are separate from observed evidence.

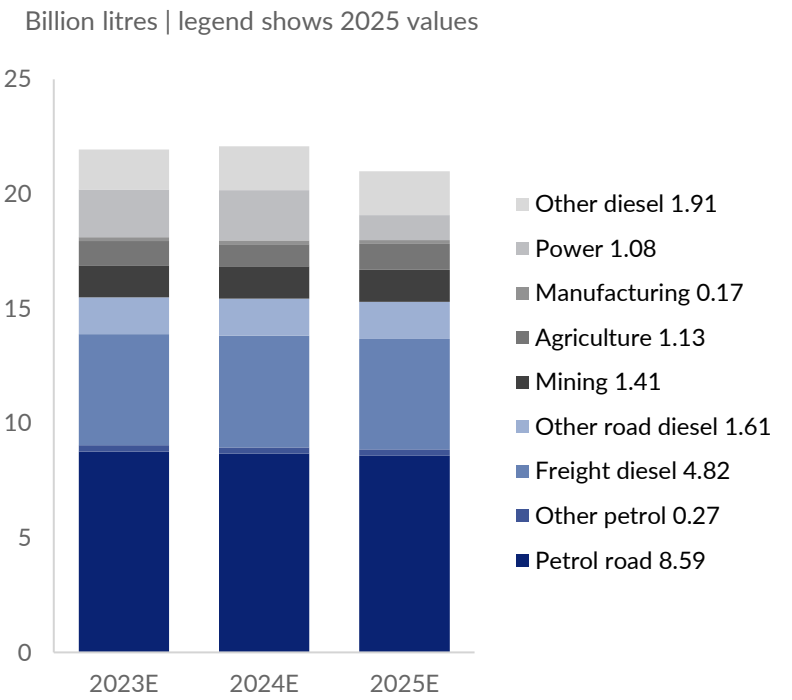
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South Africa's estimated 21bn-litre fuel market is dominated by road demand

Petrol and diesel demand, 2013–2025



Estimated demand by use, 2023–2025



Demand is estimated at 20.99bn litres in 2025; road uses account for most allocated demand.

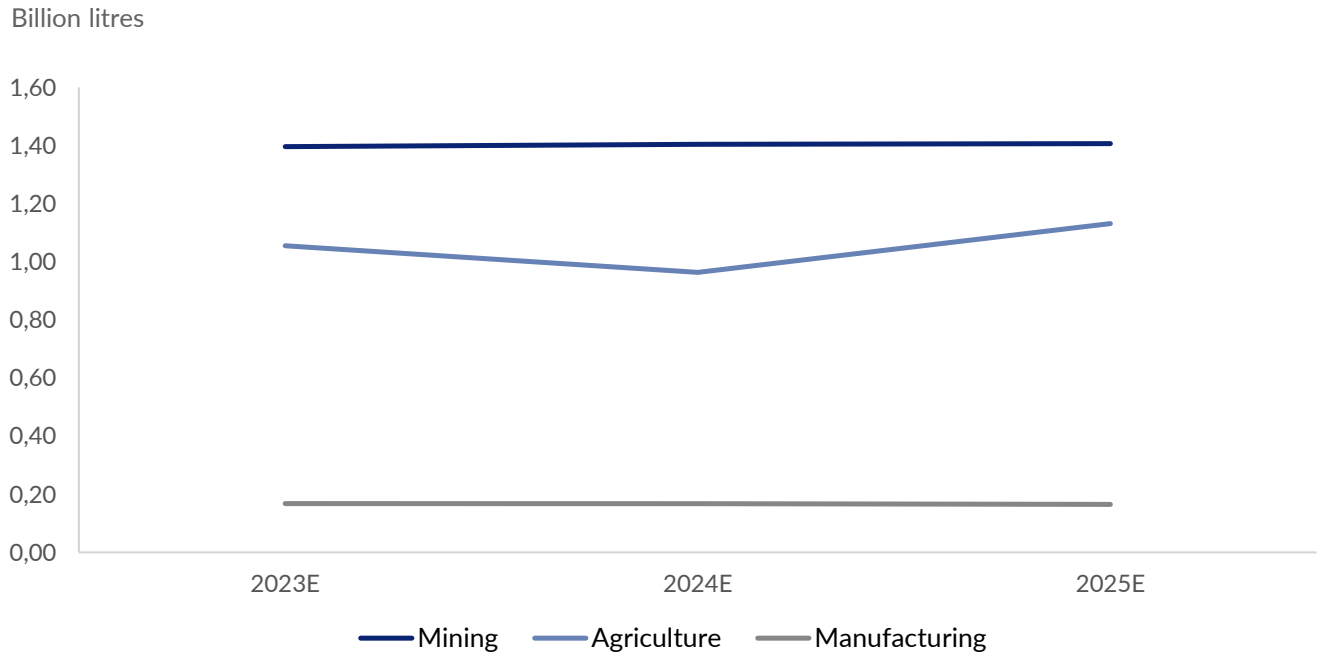
Totals: 21.94, 22.08 and 20.99bn litres. Allocations are estimates; manufacturing is an industry residual.

Department annual sales, 2013–2023. Estimated 2024–2025: analytical workbook v02. The Department series is used consistently. Segment split: analytical workbook v02, Segments. Displayed figures rounded; other diesel remains unallocated.

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Agricultural fuel demand rebounds while mining and manufacturing remain broadly flat

Estimated sector diesel demand



Sector activity produces different demand paths; applying one GDP growth rate would hide these differences.

Estimated diesel use

Mining: 1.40 → 1.41bn L

Agriculture: 1.06 → 1.13bn L

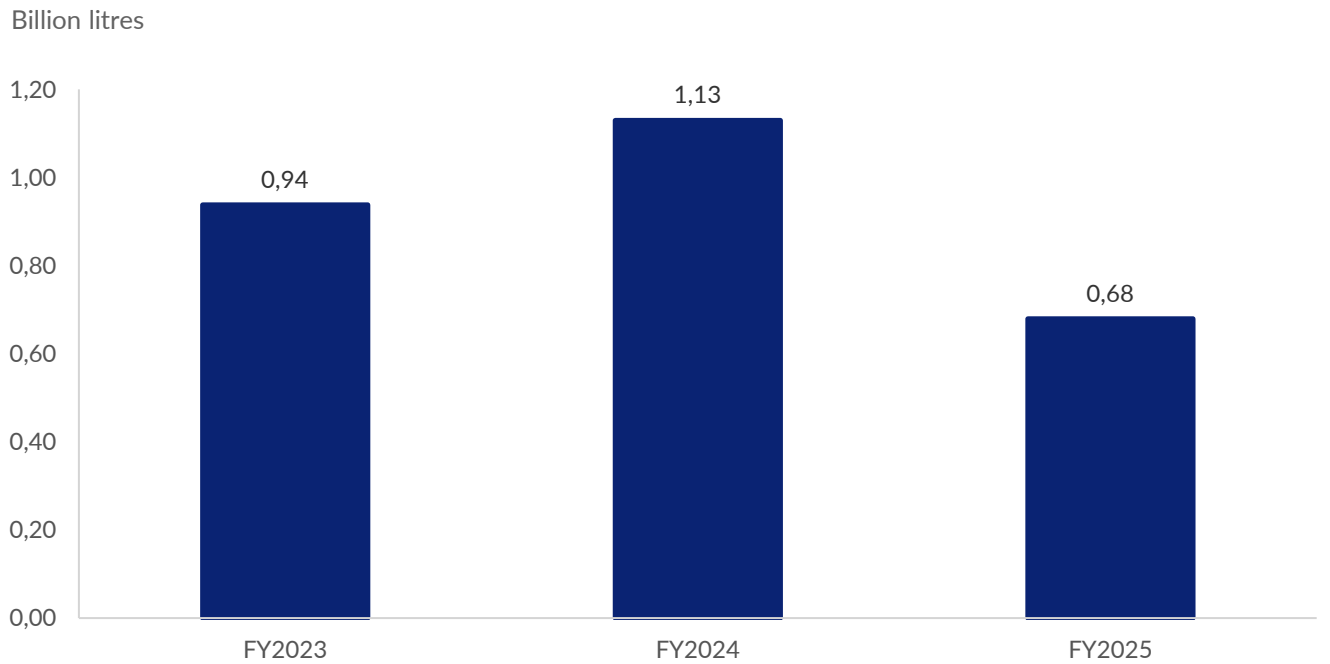
Manufacturing: about 0.17bn L

Manufacturing covers the energy-balance industry residual, not a complete industrial census.

Stats SA mining/manufacturing indices and agriculture real GVA; mean 2018–2021 fuel intensity. Sector diesel values after 2021 are estimates.

Eskom’s fuel use fell by 40% in FY2025 as electricity supply improved

Eskom diesel and kerosene use



Improved electricity supply reduces peaking and backup fuel use; the private-backup contribution remains estimated.

Power fuel use

Eskom: 1.130bn L in FY2024 → 0.679bn L in FY2025 (diesel + kerosene).

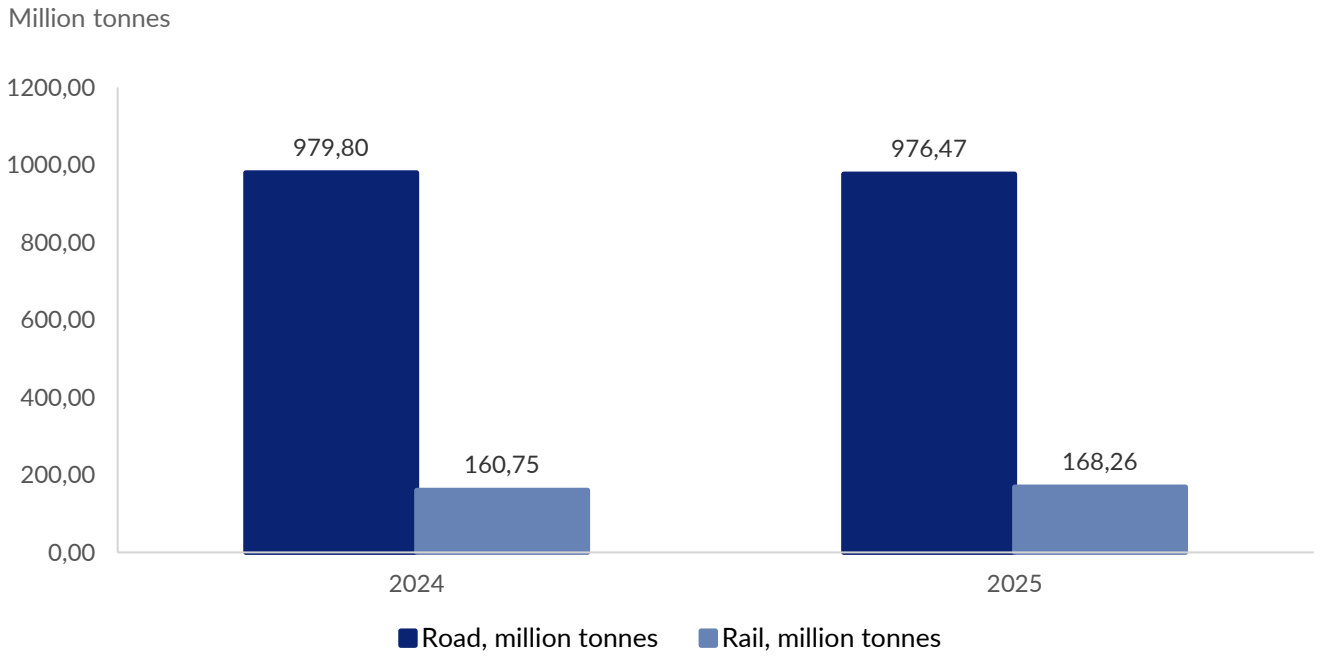
2025 utility + private power estimate: 1.08bn L, including 0.20bn L assumed private backup.

IPP conversion and fiscal-year proxies are estimates; private use is not measured by Eskom.

Eskom Integrated Report 2025, p141. Fiscal years end in March. Reported series includes diesel and kerosene; private backup consumption is outside this series. Analytical workbook v02, Segments: IPP conversion and private-backup assumptions.

Rail volumes are recovering, creating scope to reduce road diesel use

Reported road and rail freight



Road remains the dominant freight mode; sustained rail recovery could change the diesel required to move goods.

Recovery and displacement

Rail: 160.7m tonnes in 2024 to 168.3m in 2025. Road: 979.8m to 976.5m tonnes.

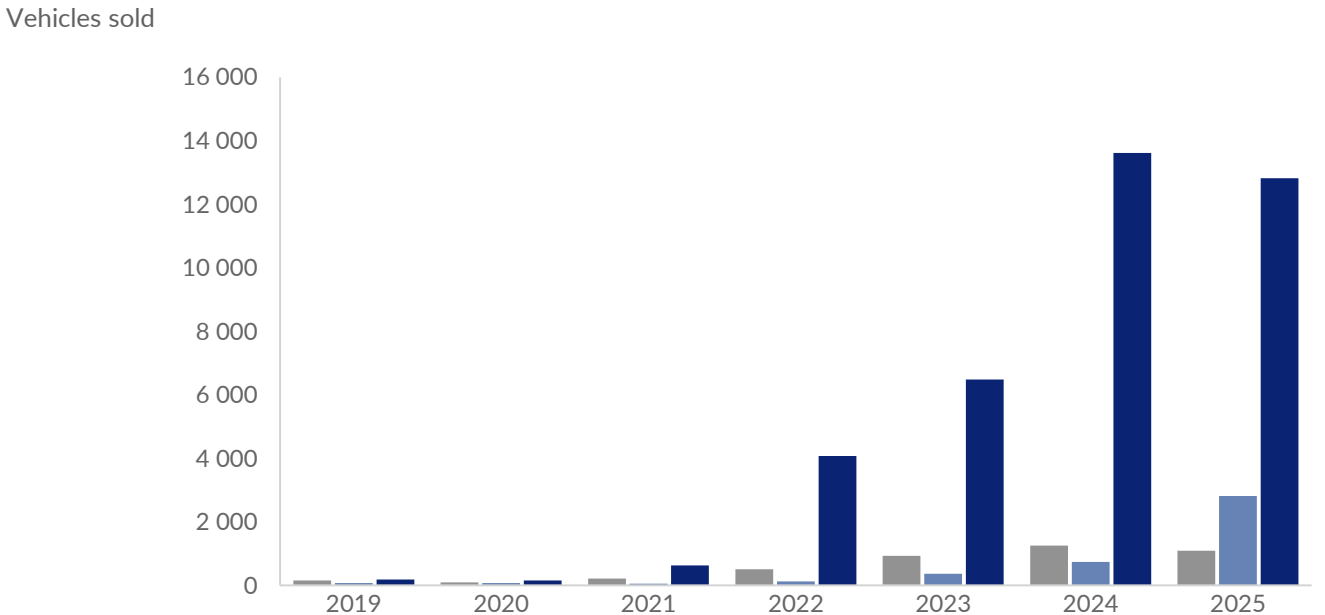
A shift of mining, agricultural and manufactured goods to rail can reduce truck fuel use.

Rail growth alone does not prove road displacement; distance, cargo and traction mix matter.

Stats SA P7162 December 2025 p7; all reported freight. Analytical workbook v02, Evidence.

Hybrids dominate electrified new-vehicle sales; fleet fuel savings emerge as vehicles turn over

Electrified vehicle sales, 2019–2025



	2019	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025
BEV	154	92	218	502	929	1 257	1 088
Plug-in hybrid	72	77	51	122	368	738	2 810
Conventional hybrid	181	155	627	4 070	6 485	13 616	12 818

The model's fuel-efficiency path is a planning assumption; new-vehicle sales alone do not quantify national fuel savings.

Different fuel-use effects

Electrified sales rose from 407 in 2019 to 16,716 in 2025; conventional hybrids are 77% of them.

BEV: 1,088 sales in 2025, or 0.18% of all new vehicles, down from 1,257 in 2024.

PHEVs and conventional hybrids still consume fuel; savings depend on usage.

New sales are not fleet penetration. Efficiency and mileage must be modelled separately.

naamsa new energy vehicle sales, 2019–2025 (Quarterly Review of Business Conditions: Q3 2024 for 2019; Q2 2026 for 2020–2025); master workbook Vehicle history. Analytical workbook v02: efficiency is a planning assumption; avoid double-counting hybrid savings.

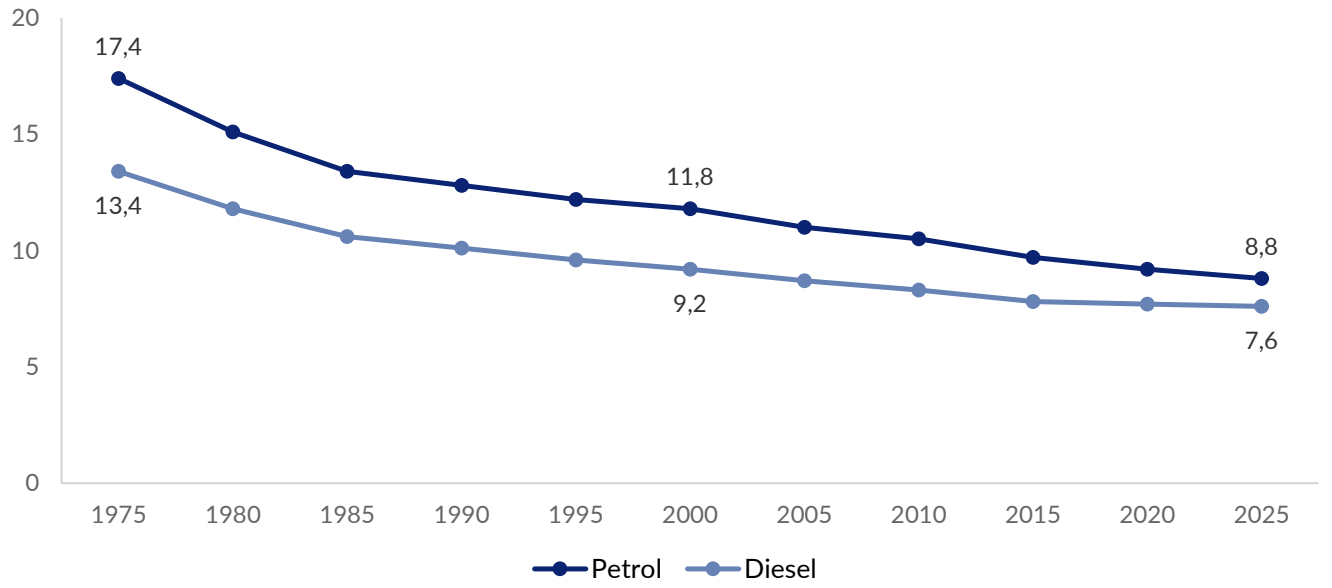
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Improving vehicle efficiency partly offsets growth in fuel demand

Get source from Nigel

Fuel use of petrol and diesel vehicles, 1975–2025

Litres per 100 km | converted from miles per gallon; source to be confirmed



The efficiency effect is a planning assumption; new-vehicle sales do not measure fleet-wide fuel savings.

Less fuel for each kilometre travelled

Fuel use per 100 km has roughly halved since 1975: petrol from 17.4 to 8.8 litres, diesel from 13.4 to 7.6.

The base case assumes 1% annual improvement in road-fuel efficiency, saving 0.79bn L by 2030.

Activity adds 1.54bn L across non-power uses. Rail and power effects are accounted for separately.

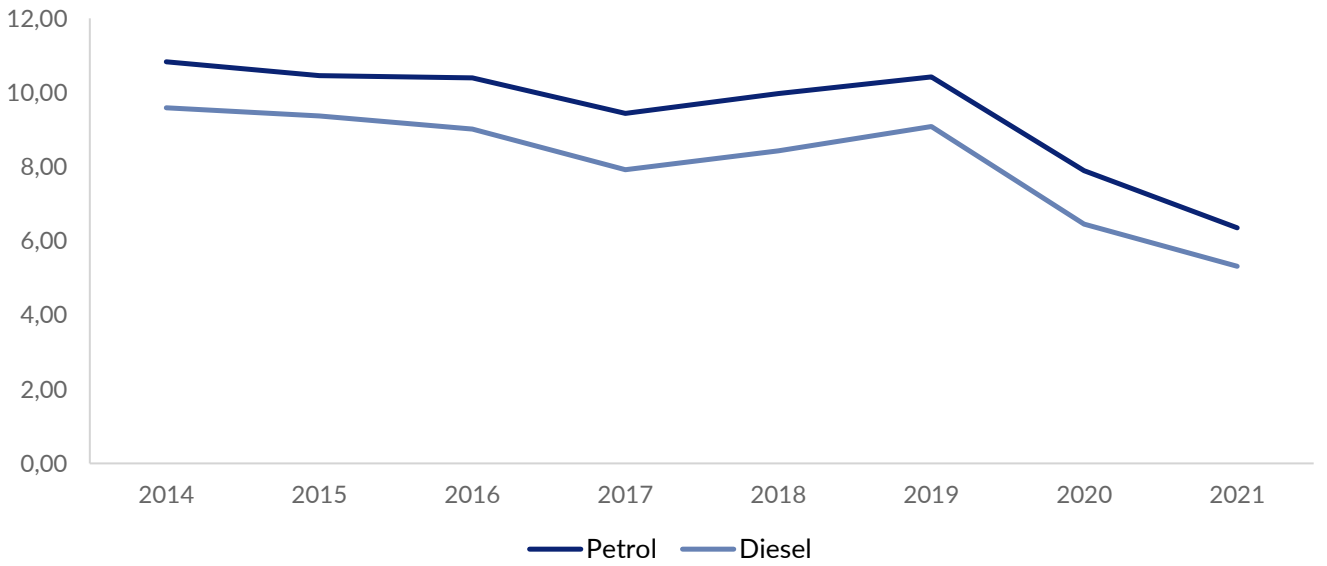
Chart: figures taken from the review screenshot of 12 October 2026 (miles per US gallon by model year, converted at 235.2 ÷ MPG). SOURCE NOT IDENTIFIED: they resemble, but do not match, the US EPA Automotive Trends Report, which has no petrol/diesel split; not South African data. Analytical workbook v02, Driver bridge (Base): modelled effects, not observed savings.

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Reported fuel production declined through 2021; the 2025 baseline assumes 5.8bn litres

Reported petrol and diesel production

Billion litres | reported history, 2014–2021



Plant context: Secunda 27.6m barrels in FY2025 → 30.6m in FY2026.
Natref reporting scope changes; Astron reports in energy units. These disclosures cannot be summed directly.

2025 planning baseline

5.8bn litres

Petrol/diesel planning assumption; not a reported national observation.

Reported combined production fell from 20.42bn L in 2014 to 11.67bn L in 2021.

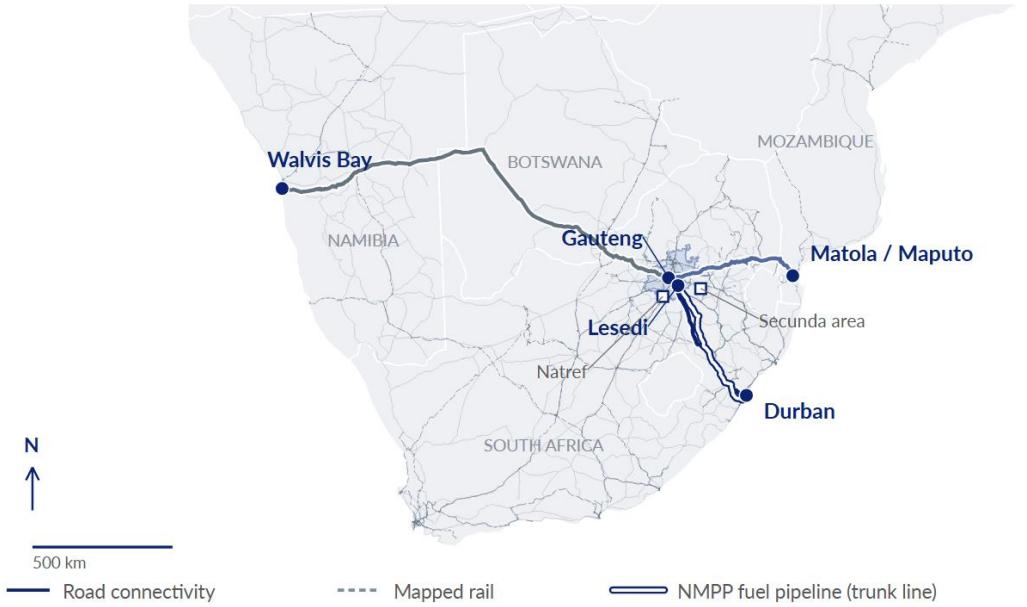
SAPREF and PetroSA contribute no refining output in the 2025 assessment. Operating output and product yields determine import displacement.

Department energy balances 2014–2021; consolidated review workbook, DR01 national balance rows 8/17. Sasol FY2025/FY2026; Glencore 2024/2025. 2025: 5.8bn L planning assumption. Historical production ends in 2021; no interpolated observations.

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Durban's inland share depends on competing gateways and reliable onward connections

Competing inland supply corridors



OSM geometry; routes test connectivity, not tanker access or operating service. Pipeline route is community-mapped.

Mapped road and rail connectivity; tanker access and operating services require confirmation. The NMPP trunk line (Durban to Jameson Park, about 560 km) is the established inland connection. Walvis Bay is a potential alternative.

Evidence and implications

Durban and other SA ports

2025 Durban customs: 13.16bn L. Allocate national imports across ports before sizing inland reach.

Durban–NMPP–Lesedi

Existing inland connection; customer/product access, receipt and dispatch constraints determine serviceable flows.

Matola infrastructure

Galp/IPG: 60,000m³ petrol/diesel; Petromoc: 390,000m³ across fuels. Do not add overlapping capacities or equate storage with SA throughput.

Mozambique flows

Komatipoort imports: 0.303bn L in 2022 → 0.086bn L in 2025. Observed flows anchor route volumes.

Walvis Bay

Comparable delivered cost, access and SA flows remain unestablished. No quantified diversion or capture is assigned.

SARS 2022/2025; Galp Matola, 3 Dec 2020; Petromoc logistics; market-sizing workbook. Map: © OpenStreetMap contributors / Geofabrik; Natural Earth; geoBoundaries. Routes show connectivity, not validated tanker access. Compare the same product and destination.

How the national fuel market translates into Vopak's addressable volume

Sizing step	Billion litres a year, 2025	Basis
1 National demand	21.0	Petrol and diesel, estimated from the Department's 2023 sales.
2 Import requirement	16.7	80% of demand is imported; domestic production is 5.8bn L.
3 Ports and inland routes	13.2	Landed at Durban: 79% of imports. Other ports and Matola take the rest.
4 Addressable market	4.3 + 6.8 = 11.1	The two markets the sites serve: KwaZulu-Natal (4.3) and Gauteng (6.8). Department sales, 2022.
5 Achievable capture	2.2	Illustrative 20% of step 4: 0.86 at Durban, 1.36 through Lesedi. Vopak's actual share is not published.

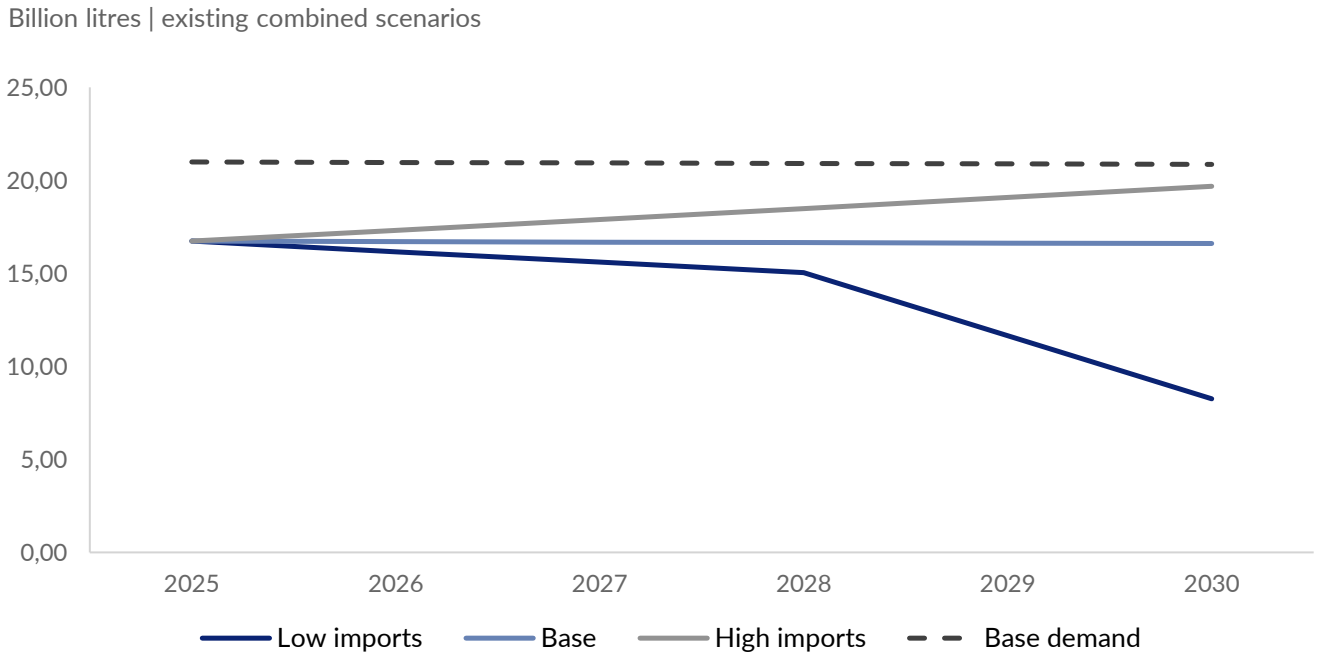
Step 6: Vopak's Durban tanks handle about 3.5bn litres a year at two turns a month; volumes above that need new tanks.

Analytical workbook v02 (demand, imports); SARS customs, Durban office, 2025; Department provincial sales 2022; market-sizing workbook. Bars are drawn to scale. Step 4: 2022 sales beside 2025 imports; Gauteng is also supplied by Secunda, Natref and Matola. Step 6: 146,000 m³ working fuel tanks (estimate) at Vopak's stated target of 2–3 turns a month. Capture is an illustrative 20%, not a contracted share. Walvis Bay is a route to assess; no diversion volume is assigned.

Check with Nigel

Refinery recovery could materially reduce imports from the 16.6bn-litre bas

Gross import requirement and baseline demand, 2025–2030



Higher domestic output displaces imports; restart timing, utilisation and product yields determine the effect.

Domestic supply drives the largest reduction

Baseline demand stays near 21bn L (20.86bn L in 2030).

2030 imports: base 16.61bn L; low-import case 8.26bn L; high-import case 19.68bn L.

The low-import case adds 0.87bn L of operating output and 5.67bn L from assumed restarts.

Demand assumptions also vary across these cases. The chart is not an isolated refinery sensitivity or a probability forecast.

Restored from South Africa story v37; analytical workbook v02, Scenarios and Driver bridge. Gross imports = demand − domestic supply + fixed 2025 exports; zero stock change. 2025 production: 5.8bn L assumption. Restart volumes and timing are scenario assumptions.

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Substantial imports sustain the market, while customer capture determines Vopak's expansion

16.6bn L

2030 national imports

Base-case imports across all gateways. Activity growth broadly offsets power, rail and efficiency reductions; domestic production stays at 5.8bn litres.

2.22bn L

Illustrative capture, Durban and Lesedi

Assumes 20% of the 11.1bn litres sold in KwaZulu-Natal and Gauteng, the markets the two sites serve: 0.86bn litres at Durban and 1.36bn litres through Lesedi.

Illustrative share; no explicit deduction for Matola or Walvis Bay diversion.

Expansion follows secured incremental flow

The illustrative flow fits the preliminary working-tank calculation.

Secure additional customer volumes, establish usable capacity, and identify the constraint that investment would solve.

Invest where secured additional volumes create a demonstrated capacity shortfall.

Analytical workbook v02 base scenario; market-sizing workbook and working-capacity assessment. Capture is illustrative; Lesedi is included within Durban flow. Contracted share, product balance and usable capacity remain to be established. Capture base: Department sales 2022, KwaZulu-Natal 4.28bn L and Gauteng 6.81bn L.

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Thank you

South Africa fuel market and Vopak opportunity

Discussion

11 October 2026



Photo source: Royal Vopak | Terminal Durban | vopak.com

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